

PowerPoint Animation and Transition — Detailed Lecture Notes

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 8, 2026

32.1 Animation and transition: the core distinction

PowerPoint can make a presentation move, but it uses two different tools for two different kinds of movement. An **animation** is an effect applied to one object or to text *inside* a single slide. A **transition** is an effect applied to the movement *from one slide to the next*. The simplest way to keep them apart is to ask where the movement happens: movement inside a slide is animation; movement between slides is a transition.

Both kinds of effect are added from the PowerPoint ribbon. Animation is managed on the **Animations** tab, and transitions are managed on the **Transitions** tab. Neither tool changes the content of the slides; they change only how that content appears and how the deck moves from slide to slide.

Definition (Animation). *An effect applied to a single object or to text on a slide — for example making a picture appear, or making a title grow. Animation acts within a slide.*

Definition (Transition). *An effect applied to the change from one slide to the next, such as Fade, Push, or Morph. A transition acts between slides.*

Point	Animation	Transition
Where it applies	An object or text on a slide	The change between two slides
Ribbon tab	Animations	Transitions
Nearest confusion	Transitions	Entrance/Exit effects

32.2 The four animation effects

When you select an object and open the Animations tab, PowerPoint groups the effects into four categories. Each category answers a different question about the object.

Effect	What it does
Entrance	Makes an object appear on the slide.
Exit	Makes an object leave the slide.
Emphasis	Draws attention to an object that is already visible , staying on the slide.
Motion Path	Moves an object along a defined path , such as a line or curve.

Entrance effects are used to reveal content step by step: the title or a bullet point appears when the presenter is ready. **Exit** effects are the opposite — they take an object off the slide once it is no longer needed. An entrance and an exit are not the same as an emphasis: an emphasis

effect does not add or remove the object, it only makes the object stand out while it remains on the slide. A **motion path** is different again: it changes the object's position, moving it from one place to another along a drawn path.

Example 32.2.1. *A presenter wants a logo to travel from the left edge to the corner of the slide. That is a **Motion Path**, because the object's position changes during the show. If instead the logo simply spins once and stops in the same place, that is an **Emphasis** effect. If the logo is not on the slide at all until clicked, that is an **Entrance** effect.*

Animations can be set to start when the slide appears or when the presenter clicks, and each effect has a duration. The order and timing of the effects on one slide are controlled from the **Animation Pane**.

32.3 Transitions and Morph

A transition plays as the presentation moves from the current slide to the next. Common transitions include **Fade**, **Push**, **Wipe**, and **Dissolve**. Each transition can be given a duration and an optional sound. From the Transitions tab, the **Apply To All** button copies the chosen transition to every slide in the deck.

Transitions are often grouped by the strength of their effect. **Subtle** transitions, such as Fade and Wipe, are gentle and professional. **Exciting** transitions, such as Push and Split, use stronger movement. **Dynamic Content** transitions respond to the slide content itself.

Definition (Morph). *A modern transition that smoothly moves and animates objects as one slide changes into the next. Morph works best when two slides share similar objects, so the objects appear to glide from their old position to their new one.*

Example 32.3.1. *Slide 1 shows a circle on the left side; slide 2 shows the same circle on the right side. With **Morph** applied to slide 2, the circle appears to slide smoothly across the screen instead of jumping. Because Morph is a transition, it is applied from the **Transitions** tab, not the **Animations** tab.*

32.4 Starting and controlling the slide show

The slide show has a small set of shortcut keys that JKSSB papers ask about directly. The most important is **F5**, which starts the slide show from the beginning — that is, from the first slide. **Shift+F5** starts the slide show from the current slide — the one selected. **Alt+F5** starts the presentation in **Presenter View**. **Esc** ends a running slide show.

Key	Action
F5	Start the slide show from the beginning .
Shift+F5	Start the slide show from the current slide.
Alt+F5	Start the presentation in Presenter View .
Esc	End the slide show.

Once the show is running, more controls are available. The keys **N**, **Enter**, **Space**, or the right arrow advance to the next slide or animation; **P** or the left arrow go back to the previous slide. Pressing **B** turns the screen black and **W** turns it white, which is useful for pausing discussion. Typing a slide number and pressing **Enter** jumps straight to that slide.

Example 32.4.1. *An item asks, “Which key starts the slide show from the beginning?” Trace the key set: F5 is the full show from the first slide, Shift+F5 is from the current slide, Alt+F5 opens Presenter View, and F7 is the spelling and grammar check. The answer is **F5**. A distractor that offers F7 is testing whether you confuse the show shortcut with spell check.*

32.5 Speaker notes, views and handouts

The **Notes pane** sits below the slide in Normal view and holds **speaker notes** — the reminders the presenter reads while presenting. Notes are not shown on the projected slide during a normal slide show; in **Presenter View** the notes are visible only to the presenter, along with the current slide, the next slide, and a timer.

PowerPoint provides several views for different jobs. **Normal view** is used to edit one slide, with an outline on the side and the notes pane below. **Outline view** works with the text of all slides as an outline. **Slide Sorter view** shows small **thumbnails** of every slide and is the view for rearranging slides. **Notes Page view** shows a slide together with its speaker notes. **Reading View** reviews the show in a window without going full screen, and **Slide Show view** presents the deck full screen.

A **handout** is the printed version of the presentation that is given to the **audience**. Handouts usually place several slides on one page — two, three, four, six, or nine per page — and some handout layouts include lined space for the audience to write. The key contrast is simple: the notes pane is for the presenter, and a handout is for the audience.

Definition (Handout). *A printed or exported layout of the presentation for the audience, normally showing several slides on a single page, often with room for notes.*

32.6 SmartArt conversion and its limits

SmartArt is a graphic that arranges text into a designed layout such as a list, process, or hierarchy. A SmartArt graphic can be converted into **shapes** or into **text**. Converting to **text** turns the graphic into a plain bulleted list, so the graphical layout is lost. Converting to **shapes** keeps individual shapes but removes the SmartArt arrangement, and once the conversion is done the graphic cannot be turned back into SmartArt — the content that depended on the layout must be **re-entered** or re-applied by hand.

Example 32.6.1. *A student has a SmartArt process diagram and converts it to text to reuse the wording in a document. The words survive, but the arrows, boxes, and arranged layout do not. To get the diagram back, the SmartArt must be created again, because a text conversion has dropped the design. The JA 2026 paper tested this kind of limit — which content cannot convert cleanly without re-entry — as its SmartArt item (PYQ-17).*

32.7 Exam retrieval and common confusions

Five distinctions prevent most errors on this topic.

1. Animation applies to an **object inside a slide**; a transition applies between **slides**. Movement inside a slide is animation; movement between slides is a transition.
2. **Entrance**, **Exit**, **Emphasis**, and **Motion Path** are animation effects, not transitions.

3. **F5** starts from the beginning; **Shift+F5** starts from the current slide; **Alt+F5** opens Presenter View; **Esc** ends the show. Do not confuse F5 with F7 (spell check) (TRAP-32).
4. The **Notes pane** is for the presenter; a **handout** is for the audience; **Slide Sorter** is for reordering slides.
5. **SmartArt** converted to text loses its graphical layout and may need the content re-entered.

Example 32.7.1. *An item lists four effects and asks which one is a transition. Read each option against the definition: Entrance, Exit, and Emphasis all act on an object within a slide, while Fade acts on the move between slides. Fade is the transition. The same logic applies when an option offers Morph: Morph is a transition, so it belongs with Fade, not with the animation effects.*

Exercises

1. Distinguish an animation from a transition, giving one example of each.
2. Name the four animation effect categories and state what each does.
3. State the action of F5, Shift+F5, Alt+F5, and Esc during a slide show.
4. Explain what the Notes pane is for and how a handout differs from it.
5. What happens to a SmartArt graphic when it is converted to text?

Solutions

1. An animation is an effect on one object or text inside a slide (for example, a picture entering). A transition is an effect on the change between two slides (for example, a Fade).
2. Entrance makes an object appear; Exit makes an object leave; Emphasis draws attention to an object that stays on the slide; Motion Path moves an object along a defined path.
3. F5 starts the show from the beginning; Shift+F5 starts from the current slide; Alt+F5 starts Presenter View; Esc ends the show.
4. The Notes pane holds speaker notes for the presenter and is not shown to the audience during a normal show. A handout is the printed layout given to the audience, usually with several slides per page and room to write.
5. It becomes a plain bulleted list; the graphical layout is lost, and the design must be re-applied or the SmartArt re-created.